

Looking Back

The Almonte Gazette
Friday, August 6, 1880

We are informed that an animated discussion took place at the meeting of the School Board on Tuesday night last. It seems that Prof. Wilson has been using the school-house free for singing class, for which he receives pay. We understand Dr. Mostyn found fault with the use of the school-house for such a purpose, and also with the very way in which the use had been obtained, the matter not having been brought before the Board at all.

Mr. Archibald Sirreffe has filled the responsible position of Superintendent of the Rosamond Woolen Co.'s mill, Almonte, for the past five years, and this week retired from the post to enter into business on his own account as a partner with Mr. And. Elliott, woolen manufacturer.

We hear that it is likely the St. Vincent de Paul Society, will this year visit Almonte, instead of making their usual trip to Ogdensburg. They will be welcome to the Dominion of Manchester.

50 Years Ago
Friday, August 8, 1930

Charlie Whalley of Toronto, a famous athlete who resided in Almonte 38 years ago, is back in the old town for a visit. In his time Charlie as a champion runner competed in the big meets of Canada and the United States.

Residents along Elgin Street will have curbs and gutters along with the present road paving as a result of a petition filed with the council by the ratepayers and acted upon at a special meeting held Friday night.

The Almonte Knitting Company started operating again on July 28, after being closed down since February 8th, and is now running three sets of cards out of its capacity of six.

While travelling at a good clip on the Pakenham Almonte highway, Monday night, a big truck owned by a Toronto construction company, hit a cement pillar supporting the rail on one side of the narrow bridge and took a good sized chunk out of it. Motorists claim the bridge in question is one of the worst menaces to safety on any provincial highway in Ontario. It is said the only vehicles that could pass on this bridge without colliding are bicycles and not many of them are at large these days.

25 Years Ago
Thursday, August 18, 1955

Hurricane "Connie" as it was called by the United States weather forecasters, blew itself out around here with little or no damage. The tops of trees thrashed around crazily as Saturday afternoon turned into evening.

This summer's drought marred the Almonte Horticultural Society's flower show which was held on Saturday afternoon and evening in the council chamber. Flowers everywhere are not up to standard and in many cases, otherwise successful growers got discouraged and gave them up for a bad job.

Contractor Fred Larose has begun removing machinery from the old sheds on the market square and the structure is about half torn down. The council decided at a recent meeting to change this large space in the centre of the town into a respectable looking parking lot.

The Almonte Building Supply has secured the contract for building the Government monitoring station on 13 acres of land purchased from Mr. D. H. Lowry.

On Sunday morning, Rev. Arthur Hirtle, B.A., B.D., tendered his resignation as minister of Almonte and Carleton Place Baptist churches to accept a call to Mack Avenue Baptist Church, Sarnia, and the Bunyan Church of Sarnia Township, effective the middle of October.

10 Years Ago
Thursday, August 20, 1970

What future use will be made of the vacant former Church Street Public School was discussed at Tuesday night's meeting of Almonte Town Council. John Dunn, chairman of the Property Committee of Council presented a memo to the members outlining some of the uses to which the building could be put. Among them were: a day care centre, adult education purposes and facilities for Senior Citizens.

A special attraction of this year's Almonte Fair will be the R.C.M.P. Mounted Arms Display Team. This popular group, which is permanently quartered in Ottawa, will perform both Friday and Saturday, afternoon and evening.

In an effort to raise funds to pay for ice time that will be used for Minor Hockey games this season an auction sale will be held tomorrow evening, Friday, 7:30 p.m. at the Almonte Community Centre.

Have you noticed the new Almonte Community Events Publicity Board at the corner of Bridge and Mill streets in Almonte? It's lighted in the evening and supported by the Almonte Recreation and Community Centre Committee with the co-operation of the town's merchants.

Beach nite for teens

There will be something special for teenagers next week when Concession 12 performs at a beach party and dance at the Almonte fairgrounds.

The outdoor dance is being sponsored by the Almonte centennial committee and the town department of parks and recreation. Admission is \$1.00.

From 8 to 12 pm Thursday Aug. 7 teenagers are invited to take part in this dance which is specially for them.

In case of rain, the dance will be held in the agricultural hall.

To run with horses

A young Almonte runner will test her strength against man and horse together next week, when she takes part in the 4-H club runner-rider race.

Angie Holeheimer, 20, is going to run the entire six miles of the race, which takes place Sunday Aug. 10.

She will compete alone against the other combined runner-rider-horse teams that will alternate along the course.

Angie is a physical education student at Waterloo University. She is working this summer both as a groom in a local stable and as a recreation supervisor.

Crafts on display

Of special interest to those who thrive on nostalgia will be the displays set up in the Centennial Center from August 2-9.

The branches of the Lanark North Women's Institutes will be displaying their Tweedsmuir Histories and demonstrating old-time crafts and procedures during Centennial Week.

The "Country Kitchen Memories" display in the alcove will remain until August 11 but different women will demonstrate their crafts from 10 am to 5 pm.

The schedule of branches is as follows: Saturday August 2, Clayton and Almonte demonstrating "Handwork"; Monday August 4, Ramsay showing "Washday Blues"; Tuesday August 5, Beckwith.

Wednesday August 6, Pakenham and Cedar Hill demonstrating weaving; Thursday August 7, Rocky Ridge showing Rug Hooking; Friday August 8, Appleton demonstrating; Saturday August 9, Union Hall and Rosetta showing "Handwork".

The Tweedsmuir Histories are a valuable record of local history and are not on public display often so if you are interested in a certain area, come the day that branch is on hand.

An additional feature will be the district quilt which has just been completed. Each branch designed a quilt block showing a special feature of their area and they were combined using the blue and gold colours of the WI.

Many hands contributed to this project and it will be in competition at the Almonte Fair so it will be displayed to be seen not touched.

Make a point of stopping in several times during the week because you will see something different each day.

Trailer stolen

Having returned from vacation last week, Harold Swierenga, of 366 Nasmith Drive, Almonte, discovered that his trailer was stolen.

The trailer, which is used for hauling antique cars and farm equipment, was in the Almonte town garage parking lot.

It was worth about \$1,000.

Armstrong family reunion

Family, relatives and friends of the late John Wilson Armstrong and late Annie Hudson gathered on Sunday, August 3, 1980 to attend the tenth annual Armstrong reunion.

John Wilson Armstrong and Annie Hudson were married December 31, 1889 at the Hudson home on the seventh line of Ramsay. John and Annie Armstrong lived most of their married life in Lanark County except for a few years when they "Homesteaded" in the West.

Their family of twelve children lived in various parts of Canada and the United States but frequently returned to the Almonte and Carleton Place area to vacation and to renew family ties.

The family registry and chart list one hundred thirty-two names. Of this number there were approximately 58 in attendance at the reunion which was held at Cedar Hill community hall.



Members of the Sons of England Lodge of Almonte gathered about 1904 to have this photo taken in their meeting rooms on Mill Street. Front row, left to right: Harry Jordan, Burt Edmonson, William Illingworth, Jack Illingworth (brother), William Coxford, James Bennett, and Samuel Bradley. Middle row: Blank, Joseph

Nicholson, Blank, Blank, James Porritt, Edward Nicholson, Sidney Lawford. Back row: Blank, Eric Turner, Wilfred Crawshaw, Herbert Warren, Samuel Davis, George Horton.

(Photo identified and supplied by Mr. Wilmer Illingworth, the son of William in the picture)

Profile of an artist

by Angela Dunn

As part of the summer-long Centennial Art Show currently being held in the Almonte Town Hall, there will be a number of special exhibitions as well as profiles of the artists.

The first of these features the work of Susan Risk of Carleton Place.

Susan was born in a small town in England and moved to Montreal at the age of 10. She has also lived in Vancouver, Toronto, Mexico, and the Yukon but settled in Carleton Place to avoid the tension of city life and to be close to nature.

During her four years at Ontario

College of Art, Susan majored in metals and has since become an accomplished silversmith. At the same time, she studied ceramics and weaving.

Susan's acrylic and water colour wildlife are some of the most highly praised work in the art show. Her attention to detail and precise brush strokes make the wildlife she paints come alive on the paper.

She hopes to move on to photo-surrealism using animals as well as people because she has a special affinity for the human form.

Interests of Susan's include the occult, mysticism, yoga, and

studied. As well, she plays guitar, writes poetry and reads when she is not nurturing her 11-year-old son or studying Tibetan Buddhism.

Her fascination for things Oriental is sometimes reflected in her painting. She loves the "sensuality and clarity" in Japanese art but prefers more detail in her own.

Apparently painting can be an emotionally draining occupation as Susan says she finds herself often crying or giggling when she paints not because she is melancholy or happy but rather because she gets emotionally involved with what she does.

CBO 920 CBC Radio

VARIETY TONIGHT presents three nights of free concerts

Thurs. Aug 7

An evening of jazz.

AURELE LECOMTE QUARTET
with Robin Moir & Barry Dale

& HAGOOD HARDY QUINTET
featuring Clarinet Kathryn Moses

Fri. Aug 8

Country Night

NEVILLE WELLS & SWEETWATER
& PRESCOTT BROTHERS BAND

Sat. Aug 9

AN OLD TIME SATURDAY NIGHT

Michael O'Reilly Donnie & Gina Gilchrist
Lennox Gavan Dominic D'Arcy
Square Dancers Quyon Old Time Fiddlers

8 P.M. MAJOR'S HILL PARK, OTTAWA
(behind the Chateau Laurier)

CBO
920
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THE
OTTAWA
VALLEY